CONCLUSION

The basic objective of this study was to explore whether terrorism in Pakistan, especially carried out by TTP, was a grave threat to the stability of Pakistan or not. After the catastrophic incident of 9/11, the US was not ready to take any chances with Al Qaeda that regrouped in FATA and kept planning further attacks on it. Its indigenous helper TTP caused immense damage to Pakistan's serenity, stability, economy, foreign relations and social fabric. The Pakistan Army and paramilitary forces were successful in dismantling the control and command structure of the terrorists in Swat in 2009 and in FATA as late as 2014. But this success could be considered partial as the higher echelon of TTP Swat fled away from the area and regrouped across the border. It carried out several attacks inside Pakistan. The terrorists in FATA had been showing tough resistance. Their terrorist activities continued for almost a decade.

The damage done to Pakistan was colossal. More than 65,000 people were killed until 2017. It caused a considerable dent to the economy and social fabric of the country. Religious extremism and sectarianism remained rampant across the country, which created a conducive atmosphere for the terrorists to flourish and expand their activities. The government could not counter them due to various reasons, including lack of political will and lack of ability. The military actions in FATA had been insipid, and a national counter-terrorism strategy was not formulated.

The campaign against TTP and Al Qaeda faced several glitches because the inception and the COIN campaign needed much more than military action. However, substantial focus of the Pakistan government and the army on curbing the militants paid dividends whenever it was